



What is a leaf?

Leaves are usually flat, green structures that grow from plant stems. Although they come in many shapes and sizes, almost all of them capture sunlight and produce food for the plant. Leaves get their green color from a pigment called chlorophyll that uses sunlight to produce food from the plant in a process called photosynthesis.

Small netted veins ➤ Networks of tiny veins connect the green tissues of the leaf to the main vein inside the midrib and the stem beyond.

Stomata ➤ Tiny pores on the underside of the leaf, called stomata, open during the day to take in carbon dioxide but close at night to avoid losing too much water.

Underside of apple leaf

Petiole ➤ This is the stiff stalk connecting the leaf to the plant stem. In some plants, these stalks can help leaves move and follow the sun in order to absorb more light.

Blade ➤ The flat part of the leaf is called the leaf blade. It is the green tissue that absorbs sunlight to make the sugar the plant needs to grow.

